

**TRANSCRIPT OF LECTURE DELIVERED ON SUNDAY, NOVEMBER 25, 2018.
(FORUM 1)**

**Theme: The King Abdulaziz University/King Saud University, Undergraduate and
Postgraduate Scholarships, Saudi Arabia.**

Presented by: Scholar: Rosheed Abdrahman, CEO Trust Edu Consult.

Moderator: Scholar Katheer Afolabi (AUC, Egypt)

Background:

The KAU-KSU offer scholarships to all prospective students who have gained admission into their Undergraduate/Postgraduate programs. The two schools were located in the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia.

NB:

KAU = King Abdulaziz University, **KSU** = King Saud University

Requirements (Undergraduate's Programs):

The following documents are important in applying for the KAU/KSU scholarships:

- ❖ Birth Certificate (Age: 17-25 years)
- ❖ A very good SSCE result or Arabic school certificate
- ❖ International passport

In addition, KAU also requires

- ❖ CV
- ❖ Recommendation letters
- ❖ Passport photo
- ❖ Transcripts

KSU requires:

- ❖ SSCE results or Arabic school certificate
- ❖ Transcripts

Requirements (Postgraduate's Programs):

Generally, age requirement for MSc. is 30 years max and Ph.D. is 35 years max

KSU requires:

- ❖ GRE, TOEFL or IELTS (for all engineering courses).
- ❖ Chemistry graduates however needs GRE chemistry in addition to TOEFL or IELTS.
- ❖ Any discipline outside the aforementioned can apply without TOEFL or IELTS for MSc, but for Ph.D., you can't.

KAU requires:

- ❖ TOEFL or IELTS

Benefits:

- ❖ Stipend for MSc. and Ph.D. is 890 riyals/month in KSU and 1900/month in KAU
- ❖ Free accommodation.
- ❖ Two months' free salary (stipend) as welcome allowance for new students
- ❖ Free medicals.
- ❖ Air ticket (to and fro) to your country during summer vacation.
- ❖ KSU doesn't have accommodation for family while KAU gives family accommodation.

Important things to Note:

- ❖ KSU accepts females also from outside Saudi Arabia while KAU doesn't.
- ❖ As for female application (both undergraduate and postgraduate), they are expected to have a male guardian who must be resident in Saudi Arabia for them to be eligible to apply.
- ❖ Most undergraduate programs in Saudi Arabia are generally taught in Arabic with few exceptions such as Engineering.
- ❖ Because most of the courses are offered in Arabic, students are not admitted directly into degree programs. They are first enrolled in Arabic language institute for two years depending on the level of the person.
- ❖ Medical courses and related medical courses are not offered to international students.

- ❖ You can only apply for just Science, Engineering, Arts and Humanities.
- ❖ Undergraduate program is for six years.
- ❖ Application procedure in KAU is easier, simpler and faster than KSU.
- ❖ For Saudi Arabia, as you may be aware, Admission takes between 1-3 years after application especially for KSU while in KAU, at least the following year after the close of application.
- ❖ For Law, Sociology, Education, Islamic studies, Library, Geography, these courses are offered in pure Arabic.
- ❖ KSU has MSc Economics but also in Arabic with evidence that you can speak and understand Arabic.
- ❖ There is no interview in KAU while some departments in KSU do conduct interviews via Skype and phone calls.

Questions and Answers:

Q. Sir, do you mean eligibility letter is not required for both universities?

A. They don't need it. It is only the Saudi embassy that requires it.

Q. Please, is statement of purpose required for the undergraduate level scholarships?

A. No, Only KAU requires it for postgraduate

Q. Thanks for your time and for granting our invitation. Please, do you know the reason why KAUST are not considering application from Nigeria? Thanks

A. Say Africans

Q. Is there postdoc opportunity in any of the kingdom school?

A. KSU do employ people known as researchers, I think KAU also started announcing post doc last session.

Q. Please which of the programs require only SSCE for undergraduate, and when is it kicking off?

A. All undergraduate program requires SSCE or Arabic school certificate. For SSCE holders, they have to translate their results into Arabic.

Q. Thank you scholar for the lecture, my question is that for those of us that study agriculture related courses, do we have any other course options apart from the arid land agriculture which is the type of agriculture they practice there

A. KSU has different Agric programs. Soil science, animal production etc. In KAU, that is just the only one.

Q. Sir, we are aware of your expertise in assisting scholars apply and guide appropriately. Please can our scholars contact you too?

A. In Sha Allah, No problem.

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